

GTR³ The Journey of Breaking, Building, and Becoming

GTR³ is not really a story about cars, although three Nissan GT-Rs form the road markers through which a remarkable life can be traced.

It is a story about hope, reinvention, and the stubborn human refusal to accept that the place where we fall must also become the place where we remain.

Across three decades, three industries, and three extraordinary periods of rebuilding, Jonathan Blackburn's life follows a recurring pattern:

Fall. Rise. Rebuild. Evolve.

Not once, but three times.

Each chapter begins with ambition and possibility, climbs through sacrifice and relentless work, and eventually reaches a point where everything appears to unravel. Yet every collapse carries something forward: a lesson, a skill, a relationship, or a deeper understanding of what truly matters.

GTR1 Elite Technologies

The first journey begins in darkness, long before there was a successful company, a beautiful car, or any reason to believe that life would turn out well.

After twelve years of addiction, repeated stays in rehabilitation centres and mental health facilities, arrests, broken trust, and periods of homelessness, Jonathan reached his early twenties unable to imagine a future that extended much beyond survival. He had lost relationships, opportunities, and even much of his ability to read and write, but beneath the chaos there remained a restless mind that was always searching for a solution.

Recovery did not arrive as a dramatic rescue. It came through structure, accountability, community, and the simple discipline of taking life one day at a time. Through a 12 step fellowship, Jonathan began to understand that he was not beyond redemption and that the same intensity which had once driven him towards destruction might be redirected towards building a life.

Unable to find meaningful employment because of his past, he returned to the technical world he had known since childhood, when he spent hours beside his father repairing televisions and electronic equipment. With almost no capital, he began knocking on doors, demonstrating technology, selling systems, and doing whatever work he could find.

From those modest beginnings grew Elite Technologies, an audio-visual and automation company that would eventually design sophisticated boardrooms, control rooms, home cinemas, and intelligent environments. What began with a backpack, a soldering iron, and barely enough petrol to get home became fourteen years of technical mastery and entrepreneurial success.

The first GT-R arrived as a symbol of that transformation. It represented distance travelled: from the streets, the cells, and the shame of addiction to the freedom of having built something substantial through his own hands.

But success carried its own dangers. Growth became pressure, ambition became exhaustion, and the life he had built began to consume the person who had built it. When the first collapse came, it brought bankruptcy, sacrifice, and the painful realisation that achievement without balance can still leave a person empty.

On the day his first daughter was born, the car that had symbolised success had to be sold. One chapter closed as another, far more important one, began.

GTR2 Trust In Hope and iMED

The second journey did not begin with another business plan. It began with service.

Jonathan transformed his home into Trust In Hope, a recovery house for people trying to rebuild their lives after addiction.

What started partly from necessity became a deeply personal mission. Inside that house, residents were given structure, boundaries, accountability, and the practical support needed to return to society, find employment, and learn how to live again.

Jonathan understood their fear because he had lived it. He knew what it meant to face the world without qualifications, trust, money, or a clean history. He also knew that recovery required more than encouragement. It required systems strong enough to carry a person when their own strength failed.

It was through this work that he encountered another problem. Drug tests were producing unreliable results, false accusations, and consequences that could destroy employment, families, legal cases, and lives. The more he saw, the clearer the need became: people deserved evidence they could trust.

With limited resources and no conventional path into the medical industry, Jonathan began importing better diagnostic products. That small operation eventually evolved into iMED Medical Group, encompassing distribution, forensic toxicology, laboratory systems, pharmaceuticals, PCR testing, and DNA-related services.

The engineering principles learned at Elite Technologies found a new purpose inside laboratories, where precision was no longer about sound, lighting, or automation, but about results that could affect a person's freedom, employment, health, or family. The stakes were higher, and mistakes carried consequences far beyond business.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, that ability to build under pressure became critical. Laboratories, technology platforms, testing systems, and compliance structures had to be assembled while the world itself was uncertain. What appeared impossible had to be completed because people were waiting for answers.

The second GT-R came during this era. It was newer, faster, and more refined than the first, reflecting a business that had grown larger and more sophisticated than anything that came before it. Yet, once again, the car was never merely a possession. It marked a stage of life, an achievement earned through years of risk, service, and relentless work.

Then the pressure returned. Financial strain, operational complexity, personal loss, and forces beyond any single person's control began to close in. The second collapse did not erase what had been built, but it dismantled the life surrounding it.

The company was lost. The car was gone. Certainty disappeared. For the second time, Jonathan stood among the remains of a life he had spent years constructing.

GTR3 JB³

The third chapter begins differently because the man entering it is no longer the same person who began the first two.

After losing everything twice, success no longer means what it once did. Money, cars, titles, and recognition still have their place, but they are no longer mistaken for identity. What remains when these things disappear is character, experience, faith, purpose, love, and the ability to begin again.

The knowledge gathered across addiction, recovery, electronics, engineering, laboratories, compliance, leadership, fatherhood, and failure now converges in JB³, the third evolution of Jonathan's working life.

This time the foundation is not a single product or industry. It is a philosophy shaped by lived experience: people are often broken by complexity long before the systems around them fail, and hope alone is not always enough to carry them through. They need structure, clarity, memory, support, and tools that reduce the weight they are being asked to hold.

Artificial intelligence becomes the material through which these lessons can be translated into practical systems. Not technology designed to replace people, but intelligence created to protect, guide, organise, educate, and support them.

The same principle that helped one addict survive now informs the design of systems intended to help families, children, businesses, investigators, and communities function more effectively.

The third GT-R has not yet arrived.

That is important.

Unlike most memoirs, this story is not being written from the comfort of a finished victory. It is being written during the climb, while the outcome remains uncertain and the final chapter is still unfolding.

The Heart of the Story

At its deepest level, **GTR³** is not a story about becoming wealthy, building companies, or owning extraordinary cars.

It is about what remains after those things are gone.

It is about addiction and redemption, ambition and burnout, fatherhood and responsibility, failure and courage, and the difficult work of rebuilding a life without becoming hardened by what has happened.

It is also about service.

Again and again, the greatest opportunities in Jonathan's life emerged not from chasing money, but from trying to solve a

problem for someone else. A recovering addict needed a place to live. A family needed a trustworthy answer. A business needed a system. A child needed support. Each act of service opened a door that ambition alone might never have found.

The book does not pretend that kindness guarantees an easy life, or that perseverance always produces an immediate reward. Instead, it offers something more honest: the belief that no hardship is entirely wasted when we are willing to learn from it, and that the person we become through rebuilding may ultimately matter more than anything we once possessed.

It is written for entrepreneurs whose companies have failed, for parents carrying more than they believe they can bear, for recovering addicts learning to live one day at a time, and for anyone standing in the ruins of a former life, wondering whether they still have another beginning inside them.

The answer offered by this story is not loud or sentimental.

It is quiet, tested, and hard-earned:

Get up. Again.

Because hardship can sharpen us.

Purpose can rebuild us. Service can keep us human.

And even after everything has fallen apart, it is still possible to gather what remains and build something that shines.

Three lives. Three rebuilds. One unfinished journey.

A grayscale profile of a man's head and shoulders, looking towards the left, serves as a background element for the top half of the poster.

GTR³

— COMING SOON —

THE REBUILD JOURNEY.



— WRITTEN BY —

JONO BLACKBURN